

0.1 Convexity

0.1.1 Definition

Definition 0.1.1. Let $f : (a, b) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a Real-valued function. f is said to be *convex* if: For any $x, y \in (a, b), \lambda \in (0, 1)$,

$$f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) \leq \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(y)$$

Convex function has following properties:

Lemma 0.1.2. Let $f : (a, b) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a Convex function, and $a < x_1 < x_2 < x_3 < b$. Then,

$$\frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} \leq \frac{f(x_3) - f(x_1)}{x_3 - x_1} \leq \frac{f(x_3) - f(x_2)}{x_3 - x_2}$$

Proof. To show that first inequality, note that

$$\frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1} \cdot x_3 + \left(1 - \frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1}\right) \cdot x_1 = \frac{(x_2 - x_1)x_3 + (x_3 - x_2)x_1}{x_3 - x_1} = x_2$$

Now,

$$\begin{aligned} f(x_2) &= f\left(\frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1} \cdot x_3 + \left(1 - \frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1}\right) \cdot x_1\right) \\ &\leq \frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1} \cdot f(x_3) + \left(1 - \frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1}\right) \cdot f(x_1) = \frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1} \cdot f(x_3) + f(x_1) - \left(\frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1}\right) \cdot f(x_1) \end{aligned}$$

In brief,

$$f(x_2) - f(x_1) \leq \frac{x_2 - x_1}{x_3 - x_1} (f(x_3) - f(x_1)) \implies \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} \leq \frac{f(x_3) - f(x_1)}{x_3 - x_1}$$

And similarly,

$$\frac{x_3 - x_2}{x_3 - x_1} \cdot x_1 + \left(1 - \frac{x_3 - x_2}{x_3 - x_1}\right) x_3 = x_2$$

gives the second inequality. □

0.1.2 Properties

Proposition 0.1.3. If $f : (a, b) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is Convex, then f is Continuous.

Proof. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be given, $s < t$ are fixed in (a, b) . For any $x, y \in (s, t)$ with $s < x < y < t$,

$$\frac{f(s) - f(a)}{s - a} \leq \frac{f(x) - f(s)}{x - s} \leq \frac{f(y) - f(x)}{y - x} \leq \frac{f(t) - f(y)}{t - y} \leq \frac{f(b) - f(t)}{b - t}$$

Put $M = \max \left\{ \left| \frac{f(s) - f(a)}{s - a} \right|, \left| \frac{f(b) - f(t)}{b - t} \right| \right\}$. Then, for any $x, y \in (s, t)$,

$$\left| \frac{f(y) - f(x)}{y - x} \right| \leq M$$

Now,

$$|y - x| < \frac{\varepsilon}{M} \Rightarrow |f(y) - f(x)| \leq M|y - x| < \varepsilon$$

Since $s, t \in (a, b)$ was arbitrary, f is continuous on (a, b) . □

Proposition 0.1.4. Let f is differentiable on (a, b) . Then,

f is Convex if and only if f' is monotonically increasing on (a, b) .

Proof. Prove by showing both directions: right and left.

Right Direction Let $x_1 < x_2$ in (a, b) . Then,

$$f'(x_1) = \lim_{t \rightarrow x_1} \frac{f(t) - f(x_1)}{t - x_1} \leq \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} \leq \lim_{\tau \rightarrow x_2} \frac{f(\tau) - f(x_2)}{\tau - x_2} = f'(x_2)$$

More rigorously, put $\varepsilon = \left| f'(x_1) - \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} \right|$. (If $\varepsilon = 0$, then there is nothing to prove.).

Now, there exists a $\delta > 0$ such that $|t - x_1| < \delta$ implies

$$\left| f'(x_1) - \frac{f(t) - f(x_1)}{t - x_1} \right| < \varepsilon \iff -\varepsilon + \frac{f(t) - f(x_1)}{t - x_1} < f'(x_1) \stackrel{(*)}{=} \varepsilon + \frac{f(t) - f(x_1)}{t - x_1}$$

If $f'(x_1) - \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} > 0$, then $(*)$ gives

$$f'(x_1) < f'(x_1) + \frac{f(t) - f(x_1)}{t - x_1} - \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} \iff \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} < \frac{f(t) - f(x_1)}{t - x_1} \quad \forall t \text{ s.t. } |t - x_1| < \delta$$

If $|t - x_1| < |x_2 - x_1|$, then this contradicts to Convexity.

Consequently, we obtain the first inequality, similarly can prove the second inequality.

Left Direction Let $x, y \in (a, b)$ and $\lambda \in (0, 1)$ be given. The Mean Value Theorem gives that:

$$\begin{aligned} f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) - f(x) &= f'(z_1)(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y - x) \text{ for some } z_1 \in (x, \lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) \\ f(y) - f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) &= f'(z_2)(y - \lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) \text{ for some } z_2 \in (\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y, y) \end{aligned}$$

Now, Monotonically increasing gives

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) - f(x)}{\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y - x} &= f'(z_1) \leq f'(z_2) = \frac{f(y) - f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y)}{y - (\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y)} \\ \implies \frac{f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) - f(x)}{(1 - x)(y - x)} &\leq \frac{f(y) - f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y)}{\lambda(y - x)} \\ \implies \lambda f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) - \lambda f(x) &\leq (1 - \lambda)f(y) - (1 - \lambda)\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y \\ \implies f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) &\leq \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(y) \end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 0.1.5. If $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is twice-differentiable, then

f is Convex if and only if $f''(x) \geq 0$ for all $x \in (a, b)$.

Theorem 0.1.6. Let $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be given. Then,

f is Convex if and only if f is Continuous, and Midpoint Convex.

Midpoint convex is that f satisfies $\forall x, y \in (a, b), f\left(\frac{x+y}{2}\right) \leq \frac{f(x) + f(y)}{2}$.

Proof. The right direction is clear. To show the left direction, we demonstrate that Midpoint Convexity implies Dyadic Rational Convexity. Claim: For any $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$f\left(\frac{\sum_{k=1}^{2^n} x_k}{2^n}\right) \leq \frac{1}{2^n} \sum_{k=1}^{2^n} f(x_k) \quad (*)$$

Using Induction: If $n = 1$, it is clear by Midpoint Convexity.

Assume that for $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $(*)$ is True. Then,

$$\begin{aligned} f\left(\frac{\sum_{k=1}^{2^{n+1}} x_k}{2^{n+1}}\right) &= f\left(\frac{1}{2} \cdot \left[\frac{\sum_{k=1}^{2^n} x_k}{2^n} + \frac{\sum_{k=2^n+1}^{2^{n+1}} x_k}{2^n}\right]\right) \\ &\stackrel{\text{m.c.}}{\leq} \frac{1}{2} \left(f\left(\frac{\sum_{k=1}^{2^n} x_k}{2^n}\right) + f\left(\frac{\sum_{k=2^n+1}^{2^{n+1}} x_k}{2^n}\right) \right) \\ &\stackrel{(*)}{\leq} \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{2^n} \sum_{k=1}^{2^n} f(x_k) + \frac{1}{2^n} \sum_{k=2^n+1}^{2^{n+1}} f(x_k) \right) \\ &= \frac{1}{2^{n+1}} \sum_{k=1}^{2^{n+1}} f(x_k) \end{aligned}$$

Consequently, we obtain the claim. Now, let $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and m be an integer such that $1 \leq m \leq 2^n$.

Put $x_1 = x_2 = \dots = x_m = x$ and $x_{m+1} = x_{m+2} = \dots = x_{2^n} = y$. Then

$$f\left(\frac{m}{2^n}x + \left(1 - \frac{m}{2^n}\right)y\right) \leq \frac{m}{2^n}f(x) + \left(1 - \frac{m}{2^n}\right)f(y)$$

For complete this discussion, Let $x, y \in (a, b), \lambda \in (0, 1)$ be given.

Since $\frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n} \rightarrow \lambda$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$, for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$f\left(\frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}x + \left(1 - \frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}\right)y\right) \leq \frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}f(x) + \left(1 - \frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}\right)f(y)$$

Finally, taking limits then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f\left(\frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}x + \left(1 - \frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}\right)y\right) \stackrel{f \text{ conti.}}{=} f\left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left[\frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}x + \left(1 - \frac{\lfloor 2^n \lambda \rfloor}{2^n}\right)y\right]\right) = f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) \leq \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(y)$$

In sum, Midpoint Convexity implies Dyadic Rational Convexity, and with Continuous implies Convexity. $\square$

Let $f: (0,1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a convex map.

1). For any $0 < x < y < 1$, $f'_+(x) \leq f'_-(y)$.

2). The set $\{x \in (0,1) \mid f \text{ is not differentiable at } x\}$ is at most countable.

Proof. First, since f is convex, for any $x_1 < x_2 < x_3$ in $(0,1)$,

$$\frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} \leq \frac{f(x_3) - f(x_1)}{x_3 - x_1} \leq \frac{f(x_3) - f(x_2)}{x_3 - x_2}$$

1). $f'_+(x)$ exists for any $x \in (0,1)$

Let $x \in (0,1)$ be given. And, let $a < x$ be fixed.

Then, for any $0 < h$,

$$\frac{f(x) - f(a)}{x - a} \leq \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}, \text{ and since } \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h} \text{ decreases as } h \rightarrow 0,$$

so $f'_+(x)$ exists. Similarly $f'_-(x)$ exists.

2). $x < y \Rightarrow f'_+(x) \leq f'_-(y)$.

Take $\delta = \frac{1}{2}(y-x)$. Then for all $h \in \mathbb{R}$ with $0 < h < \delta$,

$$\frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{x+h-x} < \frac{f(y) - f(y-h)}{y-(y-h)},$$

so the first claim proved.

Now, let $x \in X$ be a point such that f is not differentiable.

Since $f'_+(x)$ and $f'_-(x)$ exist, the only possibility is

$$f'_-(x) < f'_+(x).$$

By the density of $\mathbb{Q}$, there is $r \in (f'_-(x), f'_+(x)) \cap \mathbb{Q}$.

And, for any $x < y$, $f'_+(x) \leq f'_-(y)$, if y is another not differentiable point, $x < y$,

then $r_x < r_y$, so the map from the set into $\mathbb{Q}$: $x \mapsto r_x$ is injective.

So, the set is at most countable.